Music Unit Plan

Class: Form 4, Term 3

Unit: From Listener to Arranger: Creating and Performing a Calypso Arrangement

Goals: This unit should help students to:

- Develop the ability to identify and analyse the musical characteristics of calypso through active listening.
- Apply knowledge of rhythm, melody, harmony, texture, timbre, structure, and expressive elements in practical music-making.
- Develop the ability to transform existing musical material into a coherent calypso arrangement.
- Develop ensemble performance, rehearsal, communication, and collaborative decision-making skills.
- Develop creative, critical-thinking, problem-solving and reflective skills through arranging.
- Use notation, graphic representation and digital music technology where appropriate to document and develop musical ideas.
- Build appreciation of calypso as a significant Caribbean musical expression and encourage students to engage with it as creators as well as listeners.

Skills, Knowledge, Attitudes and Values

Skills:

Critical listening and musical analysis

Rhythmic performance and creation

Melodic and harmonic manipulation

Arrangement planning

Instrumental/vocal part creation

Ensemble rehearsal and performance

Peer feedback and revision

Notation/graphic representation

Digital music creation and recording

Knowledge:

- Calypso as a Caribbean popular style
- Musical characteristics associated with calypso
- Rhythm, syncopation, metre and accompaniment patterns
- Melody, harmony and bass accompaniment
- Timbre, instrumentation and texture
- Phrase and sectional structure
- Repetition, contrast, variation, call-and-response and ostinato
- Expressive elements: tempo, dynamics and articulation
- Basic principles of arranging for available performers

Attitudes and Values:

- Creativity
- Collaboration
- Confidence
- Cultural appreciation
- Respect for others' musical ideas
- Perseverance

- Responsibility
- Openness to feedback
- Independence

Rationale:

This unit is designed around the principle that students learn music most meaningfully when they move between listening, doing, creating, performing, and reflecting. Rather than approaching Calypso as a purely historical unit, students will investigate how musical choices create stylistic identity and apply their discoveries to create an arrangement. This unit asks students to move from passive listeners, identifying musical features in isolation, to active arrangers who apply these features in authentic music-making. Some learners may be stronger performers than theorists, while others may understand theory but need more opportunities to apply it aurally and practically. The unit therefore connects listening, theory and performance through repeated opportunities to hear, imitate, manipulate, create, rehearse and explain.

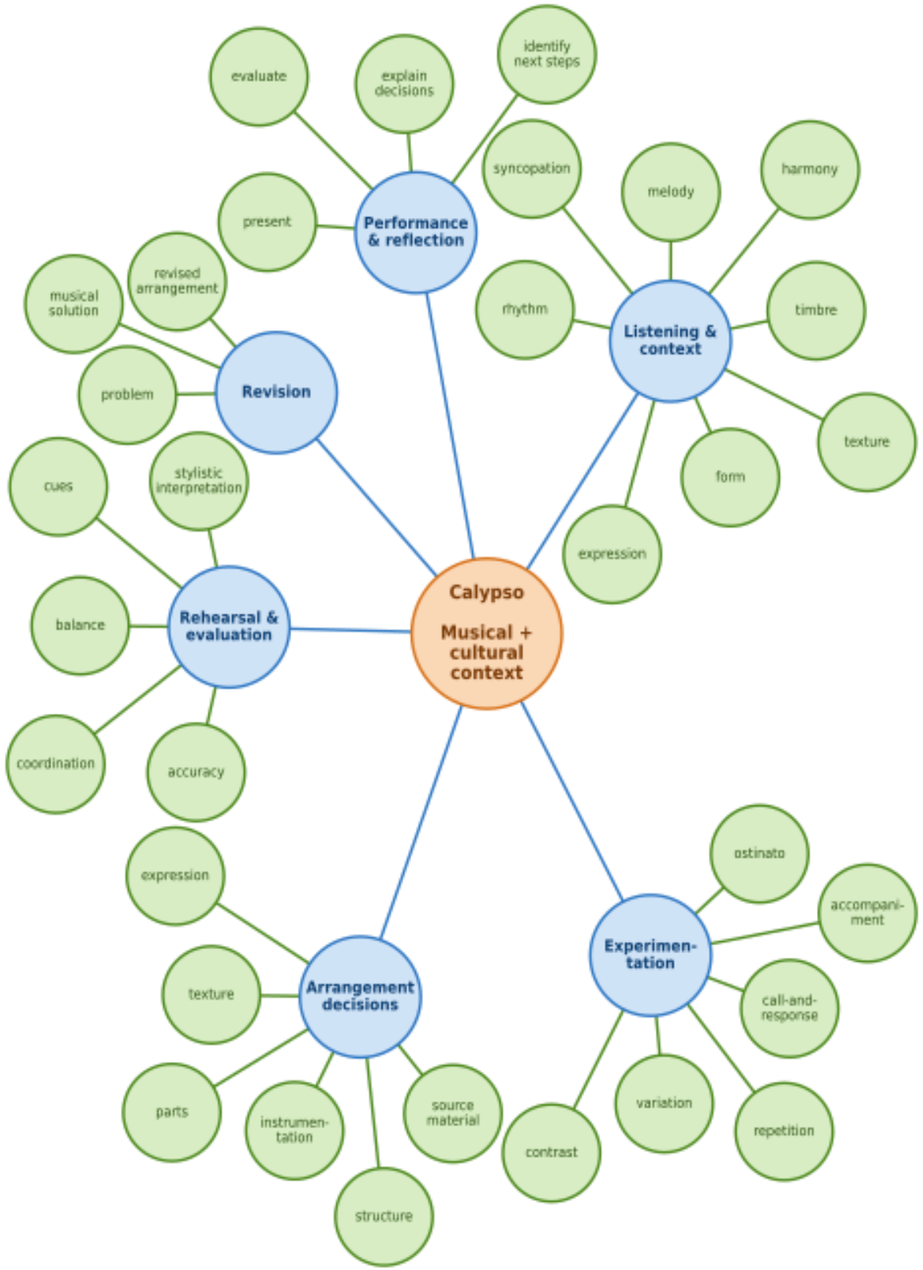
The unit begins with guided listening and practical imitation to give students the skills and tools necessary to progress into musical experimentation, analysis of existing arrangements, planning, rehearsal, performance, and reflection. This sequence provides a scaffolded approach to move students from recognition to independent musical decision-making. It also supports students who may be more confident performing without reading notation, while still creating opportunities to document musical ideas through notation, chord symbols, graphic representations, or digital tools.

The CSEC Music syllabus emphasises creativity, critical thinking, listening, problem-solving, technology, independent learning, and collaboration. It encourages teachers to use guided questions, observation, performance, and repetition to support student learning. In composing and arranging, students are expected to manipulate musical elements, use compositional devices, consider the abilities of performers, document their creative process, and reflect on challenges and solutions. This unit puts these expectations into practice through a practical, student-centred approach to creating and performing a calypso arrangement.

The unit aligns with the CSEC Music syllabus by:

- LIAP (Listening and Appraising) – identifying and discussing musical characteristics, style, and context.
- LIAP: Music Literacy and Perception – applying rhythm, melody, harmony, notation, and aural skills.
- COMP (Composing and Arranging) – mapping structure, manipulating rhythmic/melodic/harmonic concepts, using compositional devices, arranging vocal/instrumental music, scoring/recording, and reflection.
- PERF (Performing) – maintaining an independent part, responding to cues, listening for balance, rehearsal, and expressive performance.

Concepts to be taught (Graphic organiser)



Unit Content

The table below contains the following information:

- Lesson number in unit plan
- Lesson content
- Key Concepts to be taught in the lesson
- Learning outcomes
- Values and attitudes
- Resources needed for each lesson
- Teaching and learning activities
- Assessment strategies

Lesson #	Content	Key concept in the lesson	Learning Outcomes: Students will be able to	Values and Attitudes	Resources	Teaching/Learning Activities	Assessment strategies
1	Introduction to Calypso: cultural context, characteristics of calypso, rhythm, melody,	Musical style is created through the interaction of musical elements and cultural context.	• Identify characteristics of calypso through listening • Describe how musical elements contribute to the calypso sound	• Appreciation of Caribbean culture • Curiosity • Active listening	• Calypso recordings • Speakers • Listening guide • Whiteboard • Projector	• Teacher-guided listening • Calypso Musical Detective activity • Aural identification of elements	• Teacher questioning • Listening worksheet

	instrumentation, texture, structure, and expression in selected examples.		• Distinguish calypso from other Caribbean musical styles • Use appropriate terminology when discussing examples	• Respect for different musical perspectives	• Comparison chart	• Small-group discussion • Compare two contrasting examples • Class shares findings	• Observation of student responses • Exit ticket (key calypso characteristics)
2	Rhythmic Identity of Calypso: pulse, metre, syncopation, accents, rhythmic patterns, ostinato, and accompaniment patterns.	Rhythm contributes strongly to the identity and movement of a musical style.	• Maintain a steady pulse • Perform basic calypso rhythmic patterns • Identify syncopation and accents in examples • Create and perform a short rhythmic ostinato • Explain how rhythmic choices contribute to calypso style	• Cooperation • Confidence • Discipline • Willingness to experiment • Appreciation of rhythmic traditions	• Rhythm cards • Percussion/Body percussion • Audio examples • Notation/graphic rhythm examples • Whiteboard	• Rhythm imitation • Body-percussion warm-up • Rhythm card challenges • Small-group rhythm laboratory • Layer ostinatos • Perform patterns over a calypso recording	• Teacher observation checklist • Rhythmic performance • Peer feedback • Questioning • Short written identification task
3	Melody, Harmony, and Accompaniment: melodic phrases, repetition and variation, chords,	A successful arrangement combines complementary melodic and harmonic roles.	• Identify melody, bass and accompaniment roles • Recognise repetition and variation in melodic material	• Creativity • Collaboration • Persistence • Openness to musical experimentation	• Keyboards • Chord charts • Recordings • Melody excerpts • MuseScore • Laptops	• Aural comparison of arrangements • Melody/accompaniment sorting • Chord/accompaniment challenge	• Performance observation • Group task • Questioning • Aural identification

	bass patterns, accompaniment patterns, and call and response.		• Perform or construct simple accompaniment patterns • Experiment with harmonic support for a melody • Explain how accompaniment can change the character of a melody			• Students experiment with different accompaniment patterns • Call and response activity	• Teacher feedback on musical experimentation
4	Timbre, Texture, and Instrumentation: instrumental/vocal timbres, roles of instruments, monophonic, homophonic, and layered textures, ensemble balance, range and performance capabilities.	Instrumentation and texture determine how musical ideas are presented and experienced.	• Identify different timbres in calypso arrangements • Describe changes in texture • Assign appropriate musical roles to available performers/instruments • Explain how instrumentation affects an arrangement • Create a short layered texture	• Respect for individual abilities • Cooperation • Inclusion • Sensitivity to ensemble needs • Appreciation of different timbres	• Steelpans • Recordings • Instrument cards • Texture diagrams • Arrangement chart	• Texture challenge • Listening and instrument-role identification • Students build layers using voice/body percussion/ steelpans • Groups experiment with changing texture • Discuss balance and performer capabilities	• Observation checklist • Group performance • Questioning • Texture identification activity • Peer response

5	Analysing Existing Arrangements: form and structure, introductions, instrumental sections, transitions, repetition, variation, contrast, call and response, and other arrangement devices.	Arrangement involves purposeful decisions that give a piece structure, contrast, and unity.	• Identify sections within an arrangement • Trace the structure of a selected calypso arrangement • Identify arrangement devices • Explain how musical elements change between sections • Apply observations from existing arrangements to their own work	• Critical thinking • Attentive listening • Appreciation • Analytical thinking • Willingness to justify ideas	• Selected calypso arrangements • Arrangement-analysis worksheet • Structural maps • Recordings • Projector • Speakers	• Arrangement detectives • Students listen and map sections • Students identify changes in instrumentation, rhythm, texture, and dynamics • Compare arrangements • Groups explain why particular choices may have been made	• Completed arrangement analysis • Group presentation • Questioning • Structural mapping • Peer discussion
6	Designing a Calypso Arrangement: selecting source material, arrangement blueprint, structure, instrumentation, roles, rhythm,	An arrangement is created by making intentional decisions about how existing musical material will be transformed.	• Select suitable source material • Develop an arrangement blueprint • Make purposeful decisions about structure and instrumentation • Assign appropriate parts to performers	• Creativity • Responsibility • Collaboration • Problem-solving • Respect for group decisions	• Arrangement blueprint template • Steelpans • Chord and Rhythm banks • Recordings • MuseScore • Laptops	• Teacher models planning process • Groups select source material • Complete arrangement blueprint • Determine structure and instrumentation • Experiment with sections	• Arrangement blueprint • Teacher conference notes • Planning checklist • Questioning • Peer review

	harmony, texture, expressive elements.		• Incorporate at least two manipulated musical elements • Justify key arrangement decisions			• Teacher conferences with groups • Revise plans	• Formative feedback
7	Rehearsing, Evaluating, and Revising: ensemble coordination, accuracy, tempo, balance, dynamics, cues, stylistic interpretation, problem-solving, revision.	Effective arrangements develop through rehearsal, feedback, and purposeful revision.	• Rehearse an arrangement effectively • Maintain an independent part within an ensemble • Respond to cues and changes • Evaluate accuracy, balance and stylistic interpretation • Identify performance problems • Make appropriate revisions based on feedback	• Perseverance • Accountability • Teamwork • Self-discipline • Willingness to improve	• Steelpans • Arrangement scores/charts • Rehearsal checklist • Recording device • Peer feedback form • Metronome	• Group rehearsal • Teacher modelling of rehearsal techniques • Groups record rehearsal excerpts • Peer assessment • Identify problems • Revise parts • Structure or interpretation • Repeat and evaluate	• Rehearsal observation • Peer assessment form • Recording evidence • Self-assessment • Teacher feedback • Revision checklist
8	Performance and Reflection: presentation of completed calypso	Musical knowledge becomes meaningful	• Perform/present a coherent calypso arrangement	• Confidence • Pride in achievement	• Final arrangements • Steelpans • Recording device	• Final group performances • Audience listening/evaluation	• Summative performance rubric • Self-assessment

	arrangement, performance interpretation, evaluation, reflection on creative decisions and learning.	when students apply, communicate, and evaluate it through performance.	• Demonstrate appropriate stylistic characteristics • Perform accurately and collaboratively • Respond to musical cues and maintain ensemble balance • Evaluate the completed arrangement • Explain significant creative decisions and identify areas for further development	• Respect for performers • Responsibility • Reflection • Appreciation of Caribbean musical expression	• Rubric • Reflection sheet	• Teacher assessment • Student reflection • Brief group explanation of arrangement decisions • Post-performance discussion	• Peer feedback • Written reflection • Teacher observation • group viva voce